

Patricia & Harold Bennett - Retired couple with estate planning focus

ID: retired_couple **Net Worth Range:** £800k - £900k **Focus:** Inheritance Tax planning, gifting strategy

A retired couple in their early 70s in Tunbridge Wells. Both drawing Defined Benefit pensions from public sector careers (NHS and Civil Service). No debt, substantial savings, and active gifting to grandchildren. Key focus on Inheritance Tax planning.

User Profile

Field	Value
Name	Patricia Bennett
Email	patricia.bennett@example.com
Date of Birth	1955-04-22
Age	70
Gender	Female
Marital Status	Married
Annual Income	£0 (retired)
Employment Status	Retired
Former Employer	NHS
Occupation	Retired Nurse Manager
Target Retirement Age	60
Target Retirement Income	£35,000
Monthly Expenditure	£2,660
Health Status	Yes
Smoking Status	Never
Education Level	Professional
Has Will	Yes
Has LPA	Yes

Address

- The Willows, 15 Camden Road
- Tunbridge Wells, Kent, TN1 2QE

Domicile

- Country of Birth: South Africa
- UK Arrival Date: 2005-06-01
- Years UK Resident: 21
- Domicile Status: UK domiciled

Spouse

Field	Value
Name	Harold Bennett
Date of Birth	1953-08-10
Age	72
Gender	Male
Annual Income	£0 (retired)
Employment Status	Retired
Former Employer	HMRC
Occupation	Retired Civil Servant
Health Status	Yes (previous conditions)
Smoking Status	Quit long ago
Education Level	A-Level
Target Retirement Age	65
Target Retirement Income	£30,000

Family Members

#	Name	Relationship	DOB	Age	Dependent	Notes
1	Mark Bennett	Child	1980-03-15	45	No	Son, married, lives in London with 2 children
2	Susan Clarke	Child	1983-07-22	42	No	Daughter, married, lives in Brighton with 3 children
3	Emma Bennett	Grandchild	2009-05-10	16	No	Mark's daughter
4	Thomas Bennett	Grandchild	2012-09-28	13	No	Mark's son
5	Lucy Clarke	Grandchild	2014-02-14	11	No	Susan's daughter
6	Sophie Clarke	Grandchild	2017-11-30	8	No	Susan's daughter
7	William Clarke	Grandchild	2020-06-18	5	No	Susan's son

Properties

1. The Willows (Main Residence)

Field	Value
Address	15 Camden Road, Tunbridge Wells, Kent, TN1 2QE

Field	Value
Type	Main Residence
Current Value	£550,000
Purchase Price	£185,000
Purchase Date	1995-06-01
Ownership	Joint (50%)
Primary Residence	Yes
Bedrooms	4
Council Tax Band	F
Notes	Mortgage paid off since 2010. Family home for 30 years.

Monthly Costs:

Cost	Amount
Council Tax	£265
Gas	£85
Electricity	£65
Water	£40
Building Insurance	£45
Contents Insurance	£30
Maintenance Reserve	£100

Mortgages

None

Savings Accounts

1. Joint Current Account

Field	Value
Provider	Nationwide
Type	Current Account
Balance	£8,500
Ownership	Joint
Notes	Main household account for pension income and bills

2. Patricia's Cash ISA

Field	Value
Provider	Nationwide

Field	Value
Type	Cash ISA
Balance	£45,000
Interest Rate	4.5%
ISA Subscription This Year	£8,000
Ownership	Individual
Monthly Contribution	£500

3. Harold's Cash ISA

Field	Value
Provider	NS&I
Type	Cash ISA
Balance	£42,000
Interest Rate	4.0%
ISA Subscription This Year	£6,000
Owner	Spouse
Monthly Contribution	£400

4. Premium Bonds

Field	Value
Provider	NS&I
Type	Premium Bonds
Balance	£50,000
Ownership	Joint
Notes	Tax-free prize draws, maximum holding

Investment Accounts

1. Patricia's Stocks & Shares ISA

Field	Value
Provider	AJ Bell
Type	ISA
Current Value	£65,000
Annual Contribution	£10,000
Ownership	Individual
Platform Fee	0.25%
Risk Profile	Cautious / Lower Medium

Holdings:

Holding	Ticker	ISIN	Type	Units	Cost/Unit	Price/Unit	Value	Allocation	Fee
Vanguard LifeStrategy 40	VGLS40	GB00B3TYHH97	Fund	260	£200.00	£250.00	£65,000	100%	0.22%

2. Harold's Stocks & Shares ISA

Field	Value
Provider	Vanguard
Type	ISA
Current Value	£85,000
Annual Contribution	£12,000
Owner	Spouse
Platform Fee	0.15%
Risk Profile	Cautious / Lower Medium

Holdings:

Holding	Ticker	ISIN	Type	Units	Cost/Unit	Price/Unit	Value	Allocation	Fee
Vanguard LifeStrategy 40	VGLS40	GB00B3TYHH97	Fund	200	£180.00	£250.00	£50,000	59%	0.22%
Vanguard UK Equity Income	VUKE	IE00B3X1LR22	Fund	1,167	£25.00	£30.00	£35,000	41%	0.22%

Pensions

DC Pensions

None

DB Pensions

1. NHS Pension Scheme (Patricia)

Field	Value
Type	Public Sector
Annual Pension	£18,500
Normal Retirement Age	60
Inflation Protection	CPI
Spouse Benefit	50%
Years of Service	30

Field	Value
Already in Payment	Yes
Notes	Retired at 60. 30 years service. Index-linked to CPI.

2. Civil Service Pension (Harold)

Field	Value
Type	Public Sector
Annual Pension	£22,000
Normal Retirement Age	65
Inflation Protection	CPI
Spouse Benefit	50%
Years of Service	35
Already in Payment	Yes
Owner	Spouse
Notes	Retired at 65. 35 years service. Index-linked to CPI.

State Pension

Patricia

Field	Value
Weekly Forecast	£221.20
Annual Forecast	£11,500
State Pension Age	66
Already Receiving	Yes
Notes	Full new state pension

Harold

Field	Value
Weekly Forecast	£221.20
Annual Forecast	£11,500
State Pension Age	66
Already Receiving	Yes
Notes	Full new state pension

Protection

Life Insurance

None

Critical Illness / Income Protection

None

Liabilities

None

Gifts

#	Type	Recipient	Amount	Date	Notes	Status
1	PET	Mark Bennett (child)	£20,000	2022-04-15	House deposit contribution	Within 7 years
2	PET	Susan Clarke (child)	£20,000	2021-06-20	House deposit contribution	Within 7 years
3	Annual Exemption	Patricia to grandchildren	£3,000	2024-04-06	To Emma, Thomas, Lucy Junior ISAs	Within 7 years
4	Annual Exemption	Harold to grandchildren	£3,000	2024-04-06	To Sophie, William Junior ISAs	Within 7 years
5	Annual Exemption	Patricia to grandchildren	£3,000	2025-04-06	To Emma, Thomas, Lucy Junior ISAs	Within 7 years
6	Annual Exemption	Harold to grandchildren	£3,000	2025-04-06	To Sophie, William Junior ISAs	Within 7 years

Trusts

None

Business Interests

None

Chattels

#	Item	Value	Ownership	Notes
1	Jewellery Collection	£8,000	Individual	Patricia's, including grandmother's pieces
2	Antique Furniture	£12,000	Joint	Georgian sideboard and Victorian dining set

Expenditure

Total Monthly: £2,660

Category	Amount
Housing	£280
Utilities	£250

Category	Amount
Food & Groceries	£450
Transport & Fuel	£200
Insurance	£180
Entertainment & Dining	£300
Holidays & Travel	£400
Gifts & Charity	£350
Healthcare & Medical	£50
Other	£200

IHT Profile

Field	Value
Marital Status	Married
Available NRB	£325,000
Available RNRB	£175,000
Notes	On first death, assets transfer to spouse tax-free. On second death, both NRBs and RNRBs available (up to £1M). Combined estate ~£845k so IHT exposure ~£138k on second death.

Key Concerns

1. Will our pensions keep up with inflation?
2. How much Inheritance Tax will our children pay?
3. Should we be gifting more now while we can enjoy seeing them use it?
4. What happens if one of us needs care?
5. Are we protected if pension rules change under new government policies?
6. Should we consider equity release or is that a last resort?

Highlights

Estate Planning

Metric	Value
Gross Estate Value	£845,500
Available NRB	£650,000
Available RNRB	£350,000
Current IHT Estimate	£138,200
Gifts in Last 7 Years	£40,000

Risk Profile

- **Patricia:** Lower Medium
- **Harold:** Lower Medium
- **Notes:** Retired couple focused on capital preservation and income generation. Cautious approach with DB pension income security.

Will

Mirror Wills

Field	Value
Has Will (Both)	Yes
Spouse Primary Beneficiary	Yes (100% on first death)
Executor	Mark Bennett & Adams & Co Solicitors
Last Updated	2023-08-15

Executor Notes: Mirror wills in place. On first death, everything to surviving spouse. On second death, estate split equally between Mark and Susan. Specific legacies to grandchildren for education.

Bequests (on second death):

Beneficiary	Type	Amount/%	Priority	Conditions
Mark Bennett	Percentage	50%	2	On second death
Susan Clarke	Percentage	50%	2	On second death
Grandchildren Education Fund	Specific Amount	£25,000	1	Divided equally when they reach 18

Goals

1. Annual Gifting to Grandchildren

Field	Value
Type	Custom (Gifting Strategy)
Description	Use both annual exemptions (£6,000 total) to gift to grandchildren Junior ISAs
Target	£6,000
Current	£3,000
Target Date	2026-04-05
Module	Savings
Priority	High
Monthly Contribution	£500
Ownership	Joint

2. Grandchildren Education Trust

Field	Value
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Field	Value
Type	Education
Description	Build education fund across 5 grandchildren's Junior ISAs for university costs
Target	£75,000
Current	£24,000
Target Date	2035-09-01
Module	Investment
Priority	Medium
Monthly Contribution	£300
Ownership	Joint

3. Care Fee Reserve

Field	Value
Type	Custom (Care Planning)
Description	Maintain liquid savings for potential care costs without selling home. Target 3 years residential care.
Target	£180,000
Current	£145,500
Target Date	2030-12-31
Module	Savings
Priority	Critical
Essential	Yes
Monthly Contribution	£500
Streak	60 months
Ownership	Joint

4. Inheritance Tax Reduction Target

Field	Value
Type	Custom (Estate Planning)
Description	Reduce estate below combined NRB + RNRB threshold (£1M) through strategic gifting over 7 years
Target	£100,000
Current	£46,000
Target Date	2032-04-05
Module	Savings
Priority	High
Ownership	Joint

5. Annual Holiday Fund

Field	Value
Type	Holiday
Description	Annual family gathering holiday - cruise or European trip with children and grandchildren
Target	£8,000
Current	£2,500
Target Date	2026-08-01
Module	Savings
Priority	Low
Monthly Contribution	£600
Ownership	Joint

Life Events

Event	Type	Amount	Impact	Date	Certainty
Harold's 70th Birthday Celebration	Large Purchase	£5,000	Expense	2023-08-10	Confirmed (Completed)
Golden Wedding Anniversary Trip	Large Purchase	£12,000	Expense	2028-06-15	Likely
Home Care Support	Medical Expense	£20,000	Expense	2032-01-01	Possible
Grandchildren Wedding Gifts	Gift Given	£20,000	Expense	2030-08-01	Possible
Replace Car	Large Purchase	£22,000	Expense	2027-09-01	Likely
Kitchen & Bathroom Refresh	Home Improvement	£25,000	Expense	2027-03-01	Likely
Annual Gift to Children	Gift Given	£6,000	Expense	2026-12-01	Confirmed

Letter to Loved Ones

Patricia's Letter

Immediate Actions

1. Contact Mark immediately - he is co-executor with Adams & Co
2. Contact Adams & Co Solicitors (01892 523 456)
3. Access joint Nationwide account for immediate expenses
4. Contact AJ Bell about investment accounts
5. Notify NHS Pensions about death (survivor pension applies)
6. Register the death at Tunbridge Wells Register Office
7. Obtain at least 10 death certificates

Key Contacts

Role	Name	Contact
Executor	Mark Bennett & Adams & Co Solicitors	Mark: 07700 900789 / Adams & Co: 01892 523 456
Solicitor	Adams & Co Solicitors	01892 523 456 / estates@adamsco.co.uk - David Adams
Financial Adviser	Self-directed (AJ Bell / Vanguard)	AJ Bell: 0345 123 4567 / Vanguard: 0800 587 0460

Pension Survivor Benefits

- Harold receives 50% of Patricia's NHS pension (£9,250/year)
- Continues for Harold's lifetime, index-linked to CPI

Funeral Wishes

- **Preference:** Cremation
- **Service:** St John's Church, Tunbridge Wells. Reception at home. Traditional Church of England service. Hymns: 'How Great Thou Art', 'Morning Has Broken'. Donations to NHS Charities Together.

Harold's Letter

Immediate Actions

1. Contact Mark immediately - he is co-executor
2. Contact Adams & Co Solicitors (01892 523 456)
3. Access joint Nationwide account for immediate expenses
4. Contact Vanguard about S&S ISA
5. Notify Civil Service Pensions about death

Pension Survivor Benefits

- Patricia receives 50% of Harold's Civil Service pension (£11,000/year)
- Continues for Patricia's lifetime, index-linked to CPI

Funeral Wishes

- **Preference:** Cremation
- **Service:** St John's Church. Simple reception at home. Donations to British Heart Foundation.